

Marcello's Summer Adventure Pack

Keep reading and writing strong all summer — 10 to 15 minutes a day

Dear Family,

Marcello had a wonderful year — he learned to write paragraphs and essays, to use connecting words like *because* and *although*, to plan a story by drawing it, to write narratives, and to use **dialogue** (making characters talk with quotation marks). This pack is here to keep those skills warm over the summer so he comes back in the fall ready to roll.

It's meant to be easy and fun — not schoolwork. About 10–15 minutes a day is perfect. The single most important thing is the **20 minutes of reading a day**. Everything else is a bonus.

How to use this pack

- **Reading log (next page):** color in one sun for every day Marcello reads for 20 minutes. Any book he enjoys counts!
- **Two simple home habits (page 3):** one for dialogue, one for checking his own writing. Use them whenever they fit — no drilling.
- **Writing menu + story pages (pages 4–6):** fun things to write about. A drawing plus a sentence or two is great. Quality over quantity.

For screen days, there's also a website version: elcoche2025.github.io/marcello-tutoring/summer.html

★ The one trick that always works for Marcello

Draw it → Say it out loud → Then write it. When Marcello draws what he wants to say and says the sentence out loud first (acting it out is even better), his writing comes out much clearer than when he writes cold. Use this order every time.

Math note: keep up with i-Ready (about 3 math + 2 reading lessons a week). This pack is reading + writing only, on purpose, so it doesn't pile on.



My Summer Reading Suns

Color in a sun every day you read for **20 minutes**. Try to fill a whole row each week!

Week 1



Week 2



Week 3



Week 4



Week 5



Week 6



Week 7



Week 8



Books I read this summer



Read like a storyteller

A few times a week, have Marcello read a page **out loud with expression** — happy voice, sad voice, a question that goes up at the end. If he gets stuck on a long word, have him look at the **whole word** (not just the first letters), find the tricky part, then say it all.



Two Easy Home Habits

These two little habits help with the exact things Marcello is working on. Use them whenever they fit naturally — five minutes is plenty.



1. The Word-by-Word Check FOR WRITING

When Marcello reads his own writing back, he tends to read the sentence he **meant** to write — not the words actually on the page — so mistakes can stay invisible to him.

The fix: have him **point to each word with his finger and read ONLY the word he's touching**, slowly, one at a time. Pointing forces his eyes onto the real words. Reading his sentence back to him out loud exactly as written (mistakes and all) helps him hear the gap too.



2. The Dialogue Check FOR READING

When you read together and a character talks, point to the words inside the quotation marks and ask:

- "Who is saying this?"
- "Could a real person actually SAY that out loud?"

Reading it in a "talking voice" makes it click. This is the exact check we used in tutoring.

And always remember the order:



Draw it →  Say it out loud →  Write it →  Point & check it

Summer Writing Menu

Pick one any time you feel like writing. Draw it first, say it out loud, then write a sentence or two. Use a story page (next pages) or any notebook.



The best thing I did today was...



My favorite summer food and why I love it.



A summer adventure I want to have.



A day in the life of my pet (or a pet I wish I had).



A letter to someone I love — tell them about my summer.



If I had a superpower for one summer day...



The most fun place I went this summer.



Something new I learned to do.



A time I felt brave, excited, or surprised.



My perfect summer day, from morning to night.



Don't forget a TALKING sentence!

Try to put one **talking sentence** (dialogue) in your writing. Remember the chant:

"Who's talking? · What did they say? · Hug the words!"

The recipe: Who + *said / asked* + "the exact words"

My mom said, "Let's go to the beach!"

I asked, "Can we bring the dog?"

The quotation marks " " always **hug ONLY the exact words** someone says out loud.



My Summer Story

1

DRAW it

2

SAY it out loud

3

WRITE it

4

POINT & check each word

Draw your story here 

★ Try to include one talking sentence: Name + said + "exact words"



My Summer Story

1

DRAW it

2

SAY it out loud

3

WRITE it

4

POINT & check each word

Draw your story here 

★ Try to include one talking sentence: Name + said + "exact words"

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